SHIVRAJ SINGH CHOUHAN, *Union Minister of Agriculture, Farmers' Welfare and Rural Development*



Union agriculture minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said the people of this 1.4 billion-strong country should get a stomach full of food. There was a time when India was forced to eat imported American wheat, but now, Chouhan said, he could "say with pride" that the country has sufficient stocks of wheat, rice and maize, and is even exporting foodgrains. He added that under PM Narendra Modi's leadership, they have set a roadmap for agriculture, which includes boosting per-hectare production, reducing the capital costs of farming, ensuring remunerative pricing for produce and diversification. "We are now in the 11th year, and if we consider agricultural production—be it foodgrains, fruits or vegetables—it has risen by 44 per cent under PM Modi's helmsmanship," he said.

> **Cooperation is in India's soil, in India's roots. Thousands of years ago, our *rishis* said *'Atmavat Sarvabhuteshu'* (all living beings are like our own selves)**

> Even today, 46 per cent of India's population depends only on agriculture for sustenance. We cannot do without farming

> **In some instances, research happened in labs while farmers remained in their fields. The lab and land never met.... Motivated by the prime minister, we decided to link the lab with the land**

DEVENDRA FADNAVIS, *Chief Minister, Maharashtra*

> **This focus on cooperation and investment in the sector...has led to cooperatives getting a new form. It has led to a different kind of economy emerging in the villages**

> Maharashtra has always led in the cooperatives sector. Even in the future, it will continue to lead in all parameters

